

BONUS RESOURCE

Teams Meeting Productivity Pack

Copilot prompts, workflows and checklists for meetings that actually produce decisions

- 60+ copy-paste Copilot prompts for before, during and after the meeting
- Prompt recipes for 9 meeting types, from the weekly stand-up to the board update
- A 5-minute catch-up workflow for every meeting you missed
- Setup checklist, troubleshooting table and a one-page quick reference

Everything in this pack assumes Microsoft 365 Copilot in Teams. Prompts are written to be pasted straight into the Copilot pane and edited in the square brackets.

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1 Get the plumbing right first

Five minutes of setup that makes every prompt in this pack work

Copilot in a meeting is only as good as what it is allowed to see. Nine times out of ten, a disappointing recap is a settings problem, not a prompting problem. Fix this page once and every prompt in this pack works harder.

Check	What to do and why it matters
Licence	Meeting Copilot and intelligent recap require a Microsoft 365 Copilot licence on your account. Without it, the Copilot button will not appear in the meeting controls.
Transcription	Copilot works from the live transcript. Turn on transcription (or recording, which starts a transcript) at the top of the meeting. Copilot cannot answer questions about anything said before transcription started.
Spoken language	Set the meeting's spoken language correctly before you start. A mismatch is the single biggest cause of garbled names, wrong action items and thin summaries.
Copilot availability	In Meeting options, the organiser chooses whether Copilot works 'during and after' the meeting or 'during the meeting only'. If you want a recap afterwards, it must be set to during and after.
Recap without transcript	Microsoft has been rolling out an option to generate an AI summary without keeping a transcript, for organisations whose policies restrict retention. Useful if your compliance team blocks transcripts - but chapters, topics and mentions may be missing.
Names and roles	Copilot attributes statements by speaker. Ask people to join with their own account rather than a shared room device where possible, or your action items will all belong to 'Conference Room 3'.

House rule worth stealing: no transcription, no recap. Say it once at the top of the meeting - "I'm turning on transcription so Copilot can write the notes" - and you have consent, a record and a working assistant in one sentence.

2 Anatomy of a prompt that earns its keep

Why "summarise this meeting" is the weakest thing you can ask

Most people ask Copilot to "summarise the meeting" and then complain that the summary is bland. A bland prompt gets a bland answer. Every high-value prompt in this pack is built from the same four parts.

Part	What it does
Scope	Which slice of the meeting? "In the last 15 minutes", "during the pricing discussion", "everything after Priya joined". Scope is what turns a summary into an answer.
Role or lens	Whose interests are you reading for? "As the project manager", "from the customer's point of view", "as someone who has to brief the CFO tomorrow".
Output shape	Tell it the format: a table with three columns, five bullets, a numbered list of decisions, a draft email under 150 words.

Part	What it does
Evidence rule	Force it to stay honest: "quote the exact line where this was agreed", "mark anything that was implied rather than stated", "list what was NOT decided".

THE WEAK VERSION

"Summarise this meeting."

THE VERSION THAT WORKS

"Acting as the project manager, list every commitment made in the last 30 minutes in a table with columns: Owner, Commitment, Due date, Confidence (stated / implied). Quote the line that supports each row. Add a final row-free list of anything that was raised but never assigned."

Same meeting, same transcript, completely different value. Keep the strong version on your clipboard and you will never write a meeting note by hand again.

3 The prompt library

Before, during and after - written to be pasted and edited

BEFORE

Walk in already briefed

Run these in Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat 10 minutes before you join. They pull from your mail, files, chats and previous recaps, so the meeting starts where the last one ended.

CONTEXT IN ONE MINUTE

"Summarise everything I need to know before my [meeting name] meeting with [names] at [time]: recent emails, chats, shared files and the last recap. Five bullets, most decision-relevant first."

"What was decided in my last meeting with [name or team], and what did I commit to? Flag anything I have not yet delivered."

"Catch me up on [project name] since [date]. Separate what changed, what is blocked and what needs a decision from me."

AGENDA AND PREP

"Draft a 30-minute agenda for [meeting purpose] with [attendees]. Give each item an owner, a time box and a one-line desired outcome. Mark which items are decisions and which are updates."

"Based on [document or email thread], list the three hardest questions [name] is likely to ask me, and a two-sentence answer for each."

"Turn [document] into a five-slide talk track for a 10-minute walkthrough: headline, the one number that matters, and the ask."

PRE-READS AND INVITES

"Write the meeting invite body for [purpose]: two sentences of context, the decision we need to reach, the pre-read link and what each attendee should come prepared with. Under 120 words."

"Review [pre-read document] as if I were [stakeholder role]. What is unclear, what is missing, and where would I push back?"

DURING

Stay present, let Copilot take the notes

Open the Copilot pane in the meeting and ask these while the conversation continues. Nobody else sees your prompts or the answers.

YOU JOINED LATE OR DRIFTED OFF

"What have I missed? Summarise the discussion so far in five bullets and tell me if anything was assigned to me."

"Recap the last 10 minutes. What question is currently on the table?"

"Has [topic or my name] come up yet? If so, what was said and by whom?"

READING THE ROOM

"List the different points of view expressed on [topic], with who holds each one and the strongest argument they made."

"What concerns has [name] raised so far, and have any of them been answered?"

"Where is the group actually disagreeing, versus where are they using different words for the same thing?"

"What questions have been asked in this meeting that nobody has answered?"

DRIVING TO A DECISION

"What decisions have we made so far, and what is still open? Keep it to one line each."

"We have [X] minutes left. Based on the agenda and what we have covered, what must we close before we end?"

"Draft a one-sentence decision statement for [topic] that reflects what the group seems to have landed on, so I can read it out and confirm it."

IN THE MOMENT

"Suggest three questions I could ask right now that would move this forward."

"Give me a polite way to say that [point] has already been covered and we should move on."

"Is anything being assumed here that has not been said out loud?"

AFTER

Turn a recap into finished work

The recap tab gives you notes, chapters, topics, speaker timeline and AI-generated tasks. These prompts turn that raw material into things you can send.

EXTRACT THE COMMITMENTS

"List every action item from this meeting in a table: Owner, Task, Due date, Source quote. Add a second table for tasks with no clear owner."

"What did I personally commit to in this meeting? Put it in the order I should do it."

"List every deadline, date or number mentioned, with the context it was mentioned in."

"What was explicitly NOT decided or deliberately deferred?"

WRITE THE FOLLOW-UPS

"Draft a follow-up email to attendees: three lines of context, the decisions we made, the action table by owner, and the date of the next checkpoint. Professional, under 200 words."

"Write a short Teams message for the channel summarising the outcome for people who were not in the room. No jargon, four sentences maximum."

"Draft a separate note to [name] covering only the parts that affect their team, and the one thing I need from them."

"Write my status update to [manager] based on this meeting: what moved, what is at risk, what I need a decision on."

GO DEEPER

"Compare what was agreed in this meeting with what we agreed in [previous meeting or document]. Where have we changed direction, and did anyone acknowledge it?"

"Identify every risk mentioned, even in passing, and rate each one high, medium or low based on how the group reacted to it."

"Rewrite the recap for someone joining this project cold. Assume no background."

"Which of my action items from the last meeting were followed up on in this one?"

4 Prompts by meeting type

Nine formats, and the question worth asking in each

Same tool, different job. These are the prompts worth saving per meeting type - the ones that produce output you would otherwise have written by hand.

Weekly stand-up

Short, repetitive, easy to tune out

"Give me a table of what each person said they are working on, what is blocking them, and who they asked for help. One row per person."

"What blockers were raised this week that were also raised last week?"

One-to-one

High trust, easy to forget the details

"List everything [name] raised, separated into: needs a decision from me, needs support, and FYI."

"Summarise the feedback I gave and the feedback I received, in their words not mine."

Project kickoff

Lots of assumptions, little documentation

"Produce a project brief from this meeting: objective, scope, out of scope, named owners, milestones, known risks and open questions."

"What did we agree the definition of done is? If it was never stated, say so plainly."

Client or customer call

Every word matters later

"List the customer's stated requirements, their implied requirements, and their objections. Quote the line for each."

"What did we promise the customer, explicitly or implicitly? Flag anything we may not be able to deliver."

"Draft the recap email from the customer's point of view: what they asked for, what we committed to, next step and date."

Sales discovery

Qualification lives in the detail

"Fill in what we learned against: problem, impact, current solution, decision process, timeline, budget signals. Mark anything we did not learn as a gap."

"Who on the call seemed to be the decision maker, and what evidence supports that?"

Design or document review

Feedback scattered across an hour

"Collect every piece of feedback on [artefact], grouped by theme, and mark each as must-fix, nice-to-have or opinion."

"Which feedback points contradict each other, and who holds each position?"

Retrospective

Honest, messy, easy to lose

"Group what was said into: what worked, what did not, and what we will change. Keep people's phrasing."

"What did the team say they would change last retro, and did it come up this time?"

Interview or hiring debrief

Structured judgement, fast

"Summarise what the candidate said about [competency], with quotes, and separate evidence from impression."

"List the concerns raised by each interviewer and whether anyone disagreed."

Leadership or board update

Narrative and numbers

"Draft a one-page update in this order: headline, three numbers, what changed since last time, risks, and the single decision we need."

"What questions did leadership ask that we could not answer, and who should own each follow-up?"

5 The five-minute catch-up

For every meeting you could not attend

You were double-booked. The meeting ran without you. This is the five-minute sequence that gets you to the same place as someone who sat through the whole hour - and often to a better place, because you are reading structure instead of listening to sixty minutes of conversation.

1

Skim the shape, not the words

Open the meeting's Recap tab and read the AI notes and the chapter or topic list first. Two minutes tells you what the meeting was about and where the weight sat.

2

Find yourself

Prompt: "Was I mentioned, and was anything assigned to me? Quote the exact lines." The recap timeline also marks where your name came up, so you can jump straight there in the recording.

3

Get the decisions, not the discussion

Prompt: "List only the decisions made and who made them. Then list what was left open." Skip everything else on a first pass.

4

Check for disagreement

Prompt: "Where did people disagree, and how was it resolved - or was it?" This is the part that never makes it into hand-written notes, and it is usually the part that matters next week.

5

Land your response

Prompt: "Draft a short message to the organiser confirming I have caught up, accepting my two action items, and asking the one question that is still unclear." Send it while the meeting is still fresh for everyone else.

If the meeting was recorded in English, check whether a video recap is available - narrated highlight clips of the key moments. It is faster than scrubbing the recording and better than nothing when you need tone, not just text.

6 From recap to finished work

The ten-minute handoff that closes the loop

A recap that nobody acts on is just a longer meeting. This is the handoff that closes the loop, and it should take under ten minutes.

Step	What good looks like
Extract	Run the action-item table prompt. Do not accept 'the team' as an owner - if Copilot returns one, ask it who specifically was in the room when that was said.
Verify	Read the source quote column. Copilot occasionally turns a suggestion into a commitment. Two minutes of checking protects you from confidently chasing something nobody agreed to.
Assign	Move the table into your task system - Planner, To Do, Loop, or a channel post. Ask Copilot to reformat it for wherever it is going.
Broadcast	Post the four-sentence summary in the relevant channel. People who were not invited find out, which is how you stop being asked to repeat yourself.
Close	At the start of the next meeting, ask Copilot what was agreed last time and what has not been followed up. This is the habit that changes a team's behaviour.

THE ACTION ITEM QUALITY BAR

Copilot will hand you an action item in whatever shape the conversation left it. Before anything goes into a task list, hold it to this bar.

Named owner	"The team will look at it" is not an owner. Ask: who specifically said they would do this?
Verb you can check	"Explore", "align on", "think about" cannot be marked done. Ask Copilot to rewrite each action starting with a verifiable verb.
Date attached	If no date was said, the item is a wish. Ask: which of these has a stated deadline, and which need one assigned?
Evidence	Keep the source quote next to the task until it is confirmed. It ends the "I never agreed to that" conversation in one paste.

"Rewrite each action item so it starts with a verifiable verb, has one named owner and a date. Where the meeting did not supply an owner or a date, leave the cell blank and add it to a list of questions I need to resolve - do not guess."

7 When it does not work

Symptoms, causes and fixes

Knowing the edges saves you from blaming yourself for a bad prompt. Microsoft keeps moving these lines, so treat the list as current-at-time-of-writing and re-test anything critical.

Symptom	Almost always the cause
Copilot answers vaguely or says it has no information	Transcription was off, or it started late. Copilot can only see the transcript. Nothing said before it started exists as far as Copilot is concerned.
No Copilot button in the meeting	Missing Microsoft 365 Copilot licence, or the organiser set Copilot availability to off. Meeting options are set by the organiser, not by you.
Recap available during but not after	The organiser chose 'during the meeting only'. Ask them to change it before the next occurrence of a recurring meeting.
Wrong names against statements	Shared room devices, people dialling in by phone, or a spoken-language mismatch. Ask participants to join with their own account where they can.
Chat content missing from the summary	Copilot's meeting summary does not reliably cover images, Loop components or files shared in the chat thread. Anything important should be said out loud or captured in the notes.
Summary misses a whole discussion	Long meetings get compressed. Ask a scoped question instead: name the topic or the time window and ask about that specifically.
Numbers or quotes look wrong	Always verify figures against the source. Ask Copilot to quote the transcript line, then check the line.

8 Your first 30 days

One habit a week, in the order that makes them stick

Do not try to use all of this at once. This is the sequence that makes it stick, one habit per week.

Week 1	Setup and one habit
	- Fix the setup checks in section 1 for your recurring meetings - For every meeting: turn on transcription and run one prompt afterwards - the action-item table - Nothing else. Just the table, every time.
Week 2	Before and after
	- Add the 'catch me up' prompt 10 minutes before your two most important meetings - Send one Copilot-drafted follow-up email per day, edited in your own voice - Notice which meetings produce nothing worth summarising - that is data about the meeting, not the tool

Week 3**Live use**

- Open the Copilot pane during meetings and use the 'what have I missed' and 'unanswered questions' prompts
- Stop taking manual notes in at least one recurring meeting
- Start each recurring meeting by asking Copilot what was agreed last time

Week 4**Systematise**

- Save your six best prompts somewhere you can reach in two seconds
- Pick your two highest-stakes meeting types and write custom prompts for them
- Audit: how many action items were completed this month versus last?

QUICK REFERENCE

Teams Meeting Productivity Pack

BEFORE

- Catch me up on [project] since [date] - changed, blocked, needs me
- Three hardest questions [name] will ask, plus answers
- Draft an agenda: owner, time box, desired outcome per item

DURING

- What have I missed? Anything assigned to me?
- What questions have been asked that nobody answered?
- What have we decided, and what is still open?
- List the different points of view on [topic] and who holds each

AFTER

- Action items table: Owner, Task, Due date, Source quote
- What did I commit to, in the order I should do it?
- What was explicitly not decided?
- Draft the follow-up email: context, decisions, actions, next checkpoint

ALWAYS

- Scope it: "in the last 15 minutes", "during the pricing discussion"
- Shape it: table, five bullets, under 150 words
- Ground it: "quote the line where this was agreed"

The meeting is not the work. The decisions and the follow-through are the work. Used properly, Copilot removes the part in the middle - the transcribing, the chasing, the re-explaining - and leaves you with the two parts that were always worth your attention.